

Gandhi grew ill and weak from malaria. Officials agreed to let him out of jail early in May 1944. He went to stay with a friend in Bombay to rest and gain back his strength. During his lifetime, he had spent a total of nearly six and a half years in jail.

World War II ended in May 1945. Great Britain had spent so much money fighting the war, it no longer had the resources to keep India under its rule. Finally, the British offered India its independence. Gandhi, Nehru, Vallabhbhai Patel, and other Indian leaders met to work out their new form of government. The British sent representatives to transfer power from Britain to India. But the Hindus and Muslims could still not settle their differences. Dividing the country into two (India for Hindus and Pakistan in the northwest for Muslims) seemed to be the only solution.

At midnight on August 15, 1947, India became independent. Nehru would be its new prime minister. Gandhi was sitting on a wooden cot in a hut in Calcutta when India finally became its own nation.